MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検準1級
リーディングトレーニング

第15回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜18	短文の語句空所補充
2	19〜24	長文の語句空所補充
3	25〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検準1級形式のリーディング第15回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1 短文の語句空所補充

1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) To prevent speculative land flipping around the planned bullet-train station, prefectural officials imposed a five-year resale tax to ( ) quick windfalls.

1 curtail **2** coddle **3** conjure **4** convene

(2) Although the harbor ferry's new hybrid propulsion system cost millions upfront, fuel ledgers after twelve months showed an ( ) thirty-percent drop in diesel burn.

1 unruly **2** unwitting **3** unequivocal **4** unhinged

(3) Because neonatal intensive-care monitors sound hundreds of non-urgent beeps a shift, hospital engineers tuned thresholds to prevent "alarm fatigue" from ( ) staff vigilance.

1 bolstering **2** blunting **3** burnishing **4** buttressing

(4) Far from offering a candid postmortem of the bridge delay, the contractor's glossy brochure was dismissed by councilors as self-serving ( ).

1 scorn **2** spite **3** sloth **4** spin

(5) Decades of pumping groundwater faster than winter snowmelt could recharge the basin caused downtown streets to ( ) by nearly a meter.

1 subside **2** subsist **3** subvert **4** subpoena

(6) When salt mist shorted out two coastal wind turbines, maintenance crews coated circuit boards in silicone resin to make the electronics ( ) to sea air.

1 impetuous **2** impervious **3** imperious **4** impious

(7) Rather than impose a uniform water ration on every factory, regulators created tradable permits that reward firms able to recycle rinse water most ( ).

1 frugal **2** fickly **3** frugally **4** feebly

(8) Because medieval iron nails rust and swell inside damp oak beams, shrine carpenters join roof timbers exclusively with interlocking wooden wedges that never ( ).

1 convalesce **2** corroborate **3** coalesce **4** corrode

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(9) The antitrust watchdog blocked the airline merger after economists showed it would leave island commuters at the (　　) of a single monopoly carrier.

1 mirth **2** merit **3** mercy **4** mire

(10) Even critics who questioned the museum's futuristic titanium exterior had to (　　) that its daylight galleries displayed calligraphy scrolls superbly.

1 concede **2** concoct **3** condone **4** conscript

(11) Although the island's volcanic soil drains fast, terraced stone walls trap autumn leaf mulch and create moist micro-pockets where delicate ferns (　　).

1 flounder **2** flourish **3** flinch **4** flaunt

(12) To ensure blind voters could cast secret ballots without an attendant reading choices aloud, election officials equipped every booth with tactile keypads and (　　) headphones.

1 avaricious **2** auditory **3** arbitrary **4** auxiliary

(13) Once considered a purely decorative palace pastime, seventeenth-century tulip breeding in Holland inadvertently (　　) modern futures and options contracts.

1 spawned **2** spurned **3** spooked **4** sponged

(14) Because glacier-fed reservoirs turn milky with suspended silt every July, water treatment plants dose harmless coagulants so fine particles (　　) and settle out.

1 clamber **2** clamor **3** cleave **4** clump

(15) The surgical team postponed the elective knee replacement after blood work turned up an (　　) infection that needed antibiotics first.

1 insolent **2** insipid **3** incipient **4** intrepid

(16) Rather than tear up two kilometers of cobblestone avenue to inspect cracked sewer pipes, crews threaded a wheeled camera robot to (　　) out the exact leak points.

1 fester **2** ferret **3** falter **4** fatten

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(17) When autumn gales grounded island mail planes for four days, coastal pharmacists teamed up with fishing trawlers to (　　) urgent heart prescriptions across the strait.

1 ferry　**2** fend　**3** fawn　**4** faze

(18) Despite three rounds of mediation, talks over night-flight curfews broke (　　) when the cargo carrier refused to cap post-midnight landings.

1 in　**2** out　**3** down　**4** through

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

How Urban Sponge Parks Turn Floodbasins into Plazas

For most of the twentieth century, municipal flood engineers treated intense rainstorms as an enemy to expel as fast as concrete channels could carry water downstream. Rivers were straightened into steep trapezoidal chutes, and low-lying neighborhood corners were fenced off behind chain-link wire as barren retention basins—muddy pits that stood empty three hundred and fifty days a year while offering zero everyday value to nearby apartment dwellers.

Landscape architects and hydrologists in Rotterdam, Copenhagen, and humid East Asian cities have spent the past fifteen years reimagining that single-purpose infrastructure as "water squares" and sponge parks. On dry weeks—which make up more than ninety percent of the calendar—stepped amphitheater terraces, sunken basketball courts, and rain-garden boardwalks welcome skateboarders, picnicking office workers, and primary-school classes. When cloudburst radar warns that sewer mains are nearing capacity, automated sluice gates divert street runoff down decorative steel rills into the sunken courts, temporarily holding thousands of cubic meters of stormwater safely away from basement apartments. (19), native sedges and gravel beds lining the perimeter filter tire dust and oil before stored water drains slowly after the storm.

Winning neighborhood backing requires transparent upkeep and safety design. Gentle stepped slopes ensure nobody can be trapped by rising water, and maintenance crews hose silt off court surfaces within twenty-four hours so athletics resume quickly. (20), visible brass high-water markers turn storm engineering into everyday civic education.

Blending flood storage with lively public space lets dense cities (21).

(19)

1 On the contrary
2 Along the way
3 In vain
4 Otherwise

(20)

1 Instead
2 Conversely
3 Previously
4 As an added bonus

(21)

1 gain climate resilience without sacrificing scarce recreational land
2 fence off every neighborhood park behind chain-link wire
3 keep basketball courts flooded under two meters of water all year
4 channel untreated street oil straight into basement apartments

Why Translators Debate "Domestication" and "Foreignization"

Pick up two English translations of the same nineteenth-century Russian or Meiji-era Japanese novel, and you may feel as though you have entered two subtly different worlds. One version converts versts into miles, replaces honorific suffixes with first names, and renders proverbs into brisk English idioms so the prose reads as smoothly as if the author had grown up in London. The second keeps measurements, kinship titles, and culturally specific metaphors intact—occasionally asking the reader to pause or glance at a brief note.

Translation theorists since Friedrich Schleiermacher have framed this enduring tug-of-war as a choice between "domestication"—bringing the foreign text home to the reader's linguistic comfort zone—and "foreignization," nudging the reader outward toward the rhythms and social categories of the source culture. Neither pole holds an ethical monopoly. Heavy domestication risks erasing cultural distinctiveness, flattening a Kyoto merchant household or St. Petersburg salon into generic Anglo-American suburbs. (22), rigid word-for-word foreignization can turn witty, effortless dialogue in the original into stiff, exoticized prose that alienates the very audience the author hoped to move.

In practice, skilled literary translators rarely camp at one extreme across an entire book; instead, they calibrate strategy genre by genre and line by line. Children's picture books and stage comedies that depend on split-second laughter often lean toward inventive domestic equivalents, whereas historical fiction and poetry frequently preserve foreign textures. (23), growing global familiarity with culinary and cultural terms—from bento and tatami to samovar—steadily shifts where readers' comfort boundaries lie.

Great translation is therefore less a mechanical dictionary swap than (24).

(22)

1 For example
2 Conversely
3 Therefore
4 Likewise

(23)

1 On the contrary
2 In vain
3 At the same time
4 Otherwise

(24)

1 a checklist that bans culturally specific words like tatami
2 a rule requiring every foreign unit to be converted into miles
3 proof that nineteenth-century novels cannot be read in English
4 a delicate negotiation between immediate fluency and cultural fidelity

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Seed Priming for Drought-Prone Dryland Crops

Across rain-fed farming regions from West Africa's Sahel to central India, the most perilous week in a crop's life is the very first one after sowing. Smallholders wait anxiously for early monsoon showers to moisten parched topsoil, drop dry sorghum, millet, or chickpea seeds into hand-hoed furrows, and pray follow-up rain arrives within days. If a sudden ten-day dry spell bakes the surface crust before dry seeds finish absorbing water and pushing roots downward, germination stalls—forcing indebted families to buy scarce replacement seed late in the season.

Agronomists working with village seed cooperatives have refined a remarkably low-cost safeguard known as on-farm "hydro-priming." The evening before planting, farmers soak seeds in plain clean water for a carefully timed window—typically eight hours for sorghum or twelve for chickpeas—just long enough to awaken metabolic repair enzymes and copy DNA inside the embryo without letting the tiny root tip pierce the seed coat. Spread in thin shade to surface-dry for an hour so they flow freely from sowing hands, primed seeds enter the soil with half their germination clock already completed.

Controlled field trials across hundreds of dryland plots show that primed seedlings emerge two to three days earlier than dry-sown neighbors, sending taproots into deeper residual moisture before surface soil crusts hard and outgrowing early weeds. Timing remains critical: soaking seeds too long suffocates embryos for lack of oxygen or snaps emerging rootlets during sowing, which is why extension workshops teach crop-specific soaking charts using ordinary household buckets.

Seed Priming for Drought-Prone Dryland Crops — Questions

(25) Why is the first week after sowing especially risky for dryland smallholders?

1 Early monsoon floods always wash mature grain into rivers.

2 Chickpea seeds freeze solid whenever temperatures drop below thirty degrees.

3 A brief dry spell can crust the topsoil before dry seeds absorb enough water to root deeply.

4 Birds eat only seeds that have already grown tall leaves.

(26) What happens biologically inside a seed during timed "hydro-priming"?

1 Metabolic enzymes and DNA replication start up without the root tip breaking through the seed coat.

2 The seed grows ten-centimeter green leaves inside the water bucket.

3 Salt water turns the outer seed coat into waterproof stone.

4 All starch inside the embryo is replaced with chemical fertilizer.

(27) Why must farmers avoid soaking seeds longer than the recommended crop-specific window?

1 Over-soaked seeds attract locust swarms from neighboring countries.

2 Excessive soaking starves embryos of oxygen or causes emerging root tips to snap during planting.

3 Water turns sorghum seeds into millet after twenty hours.

4 Surface-drying takes three months if seeds soak nine hours.

Reconsidering Guilds in Early Modern European Craft

Since Adam Smith's critique of corporate privileges in 1776, textbook accounts of European economic history long cast medieval and early modern craft guilds as reactionary cartels. By restricting workshop entry, capping apprentice numbers, and prosecuting unlicensed suburban artisans, guilds—according to this classic view—choked technological innovation and propped up monopoly prices until industrial capitalism swept them aside.

Over the past three decades, economic historians combing municipal court dockets, apprentice contracts, and guild inspection ledgers from Nuremberg, Venice, and London have painted a far more nuanced portrait. In an era before patent offices, vocational colleges, or consumer-safety agencies existed, guilds solved two acute market failures that would otherwise have crippled complex urban trades.

First, mastering clockmaking, lens grinding, or silk dyeing demanded five to seven years of teenage labor before an apprentice became productive. Without enforceable guild contracts binding masters to teach secret techniques—and binding apprentices not to desert mid-training once they learned the basics—masters would have underinvested in training non-relatives. Second, buyers peering at a sealed barrel of Flemish cloth or goldsmith's chalice could easily be cheated by cheap alloys or fugitive dyes; guild hallmarks stamped after surprise workshop inspections gave distant merchants confidence to buy sight unseen across Europe.

Guilds undeniably grew exclusionary when shrinking markets tempted masters to reserve seats for their own sons, yet treating them solely as enemies of progress misses how institutional trust underpinned pre-industrial skill transmission.

Reconsidering Guilds in Early Modern European Craft — Questions

(28) How did traditional economic textbooks since Adam Smith portray early modern craft guilds?

1 As charitable schools open free of charge to anyone in Europe.

2 As factory unions created in the late twentieth century.

3 As state patent offices run by royal scientists.

4 As restrictive monopolies that stifled innovation and kept prices artificially high.

(29) How did enforceable guild apprenticeship contracts support advanced skill training?

1 They assured masters and non-family apprentices that multi-year training investments and secret instruction would be honored.

2 They allowed teenagers to become master clockmakers in two weeks.

3 They paid apprentices full master wages from their very first day.

4 They forbade masters from teaching anyone outside their own household.

(30) What economic problem did guild workshop inspections and stamped hallmarks help solve?

1 They helped tax collectors weigh silver coins at harbor gates.

2 They guaranteed that every apprentice married a merchant's daughter.

3 They prevented rival cities from copying church architecture.

4 They reassured distant buyers about hidden material quality in goods like cloth and metalwork.

(31) What balanced conclusion does the author reach in the final paragraph?

1 Guilds never excluded outsiders at any point in European history.

2 Adam Smith proved that hallmarks harmed Venice's cloth exports.

3 Although guilds could become exclusionary, they also provided vital institutional trust for training and trade.

4 Modern factories should abolish patent offices and revive medieval guilds.